



GDD 57

The Family Map

You don't just marry a person; you join a family.

The full-circle callback to My Family Garden (g03). A partnership lives inside a wider web of in-laws, elders and extended family, and in India that web is daily life. It teaches how to find your place in it, set kind boundaries that protect the couple without rejecting anyone, stand as a united team, honour elders while keeping your own voice, and tell ordinary friction from abuse, where dowry demands or coercive control route straight to help. Seven mechanics, 25 choice-and-voice moments, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

Join a family. Keep your couple.

The Family Map addresses what the Western literature often skips and Indian life never does: a partnership exists inside an extended family. It helps adults navigate in-laws and joint-family dynamics, set respectful boundaries, protect the couple's own relationship within the wider web, and find their place, turning a common source of conflict into something manageable. It honours the value India places on family, never treats "cut them off" as a default, and draws a clear line where friction turns into dowry harassment or coercive control, routing those to Respect at Home (g56) and help. New v2 build, the relationship thread brought full circle to family.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g57 · family-map (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / ages	Chapter 7 · 22 → first child · adult / honest / warm-but-kind
Thread / topics	D · Relationships · UNESCO 1.1, 2.3, 5.3
Prerequisite / builds on	g56 · builds on g03 (My Family Garden) · pairs with g55, g56
Gating	Open · family-respecting; couple-protecting
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS the family-map game.

84 scenarios	7 mechanics	18 myth-flips	25 choice & voice	0% binary taps
------------------------	-----------------------	-------------------------	-----------------------------	--------------------------

Honour them; protect us; get help if it turns harmful. In India you don't just marry a person, you join a family, and the couple has to find its place in that web without losing itself. Kind boundaries protect the relationship rather than reject anyone, the couple is the new first team that decides together and presents a united front, and respect runs both ways, honouring elders without obeying in everything. And there's a clear line: dowry is illegal, and coercive control, isolation or threats are abuse, not friction, routing to Respect at Home (g56) and help.

A new web, and your place in it.

From the Chapter 7 personas (22 onward). Adults for whom "family scales up", where in-laws, joint households and "log kya kahenge" shape daily life, and the task is couple-unit boundaries that let them navigate elders without rupture.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Pooja (joint family)	Kind boundaries and a fair place inside a busy joint household.	strike-rewrite + branch: boundaries.
Karthik (the husband)	To stand with his partner as a team without "choosing sides".	branch + role-play: couple-team.
Sneha & Razia	To honour elders and traditions while keeping their own voice.	match + spot: respect both ways.
Reshma (the counsellor)	A clear line from friction to abuse, with help routes.	sort + reflect: when it turns harmful.

Why this works (the evidence). In India a marriage joins two people into a wider, often joint family, and in-law relationships are central to married life and one of its leading sources of strain (one dual-career study found roughly 72% of women reported disagreements about relatives), with expectations heaviest on the new daughter-in-law, though sons-in-law increasingly adjust too. A partnership is protected by kind boundaries and a united couple-team, not by obedience or silence, while respect runs both ways across generations. And there is a clear line between friction and abuse: dowry is illegal under the Dowry Prohibition Act 1961, dowry harassment and cruelty are criminal, and coercive control routes to help, not more adjusting.

Seven moves, led by the choice and the flip.

It's a navigation game, so **branch** leads (choose the warm, boundaried, team-first move) alongside **strike-rewrite** clearing the family myths, with **sort** drawing the lines (whose call, friction vs red flag); **role-play** gives the words for the warm "no" and the team line. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE ADULT DOES	EMBODIES	N
branch (the choice) <i>signature</i>	Chooses the warm, boundaried, team-first move.	Judgement.	18
strike-rewrite <i>signature</i>	Busts a family myth ("interference is just love").	Conceptual change.	18
reflect	Internalises kind boundaries, couple-team and mutual respect.	Values.	12
sort	Sorts whose call it is; friction vs a red flag needing help.	The line.	11
match	Pairs a harsh line to its kinder version; a moment to its tool.	Connections.	10
spot	Spots coercive control; respect vs fear; the sustainable move.	Reading it.	8
role-play (voice)	Says the warm "no", the team line, shuts down a dowry hint.	Voice; care.	7

25 of 84 moments are branch or role-play. Binary "tap the right answer": **0%**.

The two-test, passed.

Is it engaging?

Game feel is relief and competence at one of married life's most loaded pressure points: the calm of a map for the in-law maze, the quiet confidence of a warm "no" that doesn't start a war, and the solidarity of a couple that decides together and backs each other in the room. The "oh, I can be warm and keep the boundary" moment lands repeatedly. Sam is a warm adult peer; the tone is wry-but-kind, never preachy, and it honours family deeply while protecting the couple.

Is it teaching?

Yes: finding your place in the extended-family web; setting kind, respectful boundaries that protect the couple without rejecting anyone; standing as a united couple-team and refusing triangulation; honouring elders and culture while keeping your own voice; and telling ordinary friction from abuse, so dowry demands and coercive control route to Respect at Home (g56) and help.

The belief it moves. From "you marry a person, not a family; family always knows best; a boundary is rejection; always side with your parents; respect means obeying; a little dowry is just tradition" → "you join a family; the couple decides its own life; a kind boundary protects the bond; the couple is the first team; respect honours without obeying; and dowry is illegal, with abuse routed to help."

Built, not bolted on.

84 researched scenarios across the web-you-join → kind-boundaries → couple-team → respect-both-ways → when-it-turns-harmful → tools arc, India-grounded, warm and even-handed. Full library in the companion JSON.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
The web you join	14	strike-rewrite, branch, match	Map the family; find your place; both partners join.
Kind boundaries	14	strike-rewrite, branch, sort	Limits that protect the couple, not reject family.
Couple as a team	14	branch, strike-rewrite, match	United front; refuse triangulation; decide together.
Respect both ways	14	strike-rewrite, match, branch	Honour elders & culture; keep your own voice.
When it turns harmful	14	strike-rewrite, branch, sort	Dowry illegal; coercive control; route to g56 & help.
Tools & help	14	branch, match, reflect	The couple check-in, the warm "no", the help routes.

The 'interference is love' flip + the dowry flip, verbatim.

flip: "Interference is just love, so you have to accept all of it."
 UN -> "Interference is just love, so you have to accept all of it."
 RE -> "Concern can come from love and still cross a line; receive the love and decline the overreach."

flip: "A little dowry is just tradition, so it's fine."
 UN -> "A little dowry is just tradition, so it's fine."
 RE -> "Dowry is illegal in India; giving, taking and demanding it are all offences under the Dowry Prohibition Act, 1961."

Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 57 The Family Map — Scenario Library.json](#) (84 records, v2 schema).

What this game flips.

MYTH (UN ERASES)	TRUTH (RE WRITES)	BASIS
You marry a person, not a family.	In India especially, marrying joins you to a wider family, and them to you.	You join a family.
Family always knows best, so just do as they say.	Elders deserve respect, but the couple decides its own life together.	Couple decides.
Setting a boundary means you're rejecting them.	A boundary protects the relationship; saying no kindly isn't rejection.	Boundaries protect.
Interference is just love, so accept all of it.	Receive the love and still decline the overreach.	Love and limit.
In a disagreement, always side with your own parents.	The couple is the primary team; decide together, then face family as one.	Couple is the team.
Respecting elders means obeying them in everything.	Respect means honouring and listening, not surrendering every choice.	Respect not obedience.
A good daughter-in-law never says no to family.	A kind "no" is compatible with respect; it doesn't make you a bad bahu.	The kind no.
A little dowry is just tradition, so it's fine.	Dowry, giving, taking or demanding, is illegal under the 1961 Act.	Dowry is illegal.

The micro-loop.

1. **Surface.** Sam (adult peer) surfaces a real moment, an unannounced visit, a relative's pressure, an elder's advice, a post-wedding demand.
2. **Choose or voice.** The adult chooses the warm, boundaried, team-first move (branch), or finds the words (role-play).
3. **The flip.** UN busts a family myth; RE writes the warm, boundaried truth.
4. **Map & align.** See the web, agree the couple's line, present one kind, united answer.
5. **Line & help.** Tell friction from abuse; dowry demands and coercive control route to Respect at Home (g56) and help.
6. **Sticker.** The Family Map badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surface: the **warm "no"** and the **couple-team line**. It brings My Family Garden (g03) full circle into adult family life, pairs with Equal Partners (g55) for the shared load and Respect at Home (g56) where dynamics turn abusive, and rounds out Chapter 7's home as a fair, respectful, bounded one.

Family-respecting; couple-protecting; abuse routed.

- **Never "cut them off" as a default.** The node honours the value placed on family and aims for kind boundaries and a built relationship, not estrangement.
- **Even-handed.** Engages elders and in-laws as people, names that expectations fall heaviest on the daughter-in-law while sons-in-law increasingly adjust too, and never caricatures any side.
- **A clear friction-vs-abuse line.** Ordinary conflict is worked through; coercive control, isolation, threats and dowry harassment are named as abuse, not boundary problems.
- **Dowry is illegal.** Giving, taking and demanding dowry are offences (Dowry Prohibition Act 1961); cruelty by a husband or relatives is criminal (former Section 498A IPC, now Section 85 BNS, in force 1 July 2024).
- **Routes to Respect at Home (g56).** Where in-law dynamics become abusive, the node hands off to g56 and the shared "get help" component.
- **Educational, not legal advice.** Legal points are explained plainly and flagged as general information; specifics route to a professional.
- **Access & privacy.** Self-directed, audio, offline, low-end build; private by design (DPDP-aligned); expert-reviewed.

If family conflict turns to abuse (India). Control, isolation, threats, violence or dowry demands are not yours to endure and not your shame. Women Helpline **181** · women in distress **1091** · emergency **112** · a child being married off, Childline **1098** · and a couples or family counsellor. Dowry is illegal; reaching for help is courage, not failure. See Respect at Home (g56).

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. family-map** — node.game === GameDone key === registry id (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema**. type + typed payload; the **branch** warm choice and the **strike-rewrite** family-myth flip co-lead.
- **Even-handedness is a hard requirement**. Family-respecting, never-cut-off-by-default, and the clear friction-vs-abuse line are contractual; expert-reviewed.
- **Fact-checked content**. In-law strain prevalence, the Dowry Prohibition Act 1961, the Section 498A → BNS Section 85 transition (1 July 2024), and help routes (181, 1091, 112, 1098) verified this build.
- **Scorecard-gated**. Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, top mechanic at 21%, 0% binary, 25 autonomy, 18 UN→RE, 6 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run score_gdd.py on any edit.
- **Help-resource hook**. Abuse, coercive control or dowry harassment route via the shared "get help" component and Respect at Home (g56).
- **Tracked**. build_gate.py finalize advances g57 to v2 PASS only after order, read, score, audit and artifact gates pass.

Ethics contracts (never traded for engagement): family-respecting and never cut-off by default; couple-protecting; a clear friction-vs-abuse line; dowry named as illegal; abuse routed to g56 and help; educational, not legal advice; made-for-India.

Why this works.

- **The web is real, so map it.** Because in India a marriage joins a whole extended family and in-law ties are a leading source of marital strain, teaching people to find their place and build the relationships beats pretending the couple lives alone.
- **Boundaries and the couple-team are skills, so they're teachable.** Since kind, clear limits and a united front protect the partnership far better than obedience or silence, naming and practising them genuinely lowers conflict.
- **A clear line keeps it safe.** Because dowry is illegal and coercive control is abuse rather than friction, drawing the line plainly and routing those cases to g56 and help is what makes the warmth honest and safe.

Sources: UNESCO ITGSE Key Concept 1 (families) and 2 (culture, society, law); India in-law and joint-family research (in-law disagreements among the most common marital conflicts; expectations heaviest on the daughter-in-law); the Dowry Prohibition Act 1961 (giving, taking and demanding dowry are offences); the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita 2023 Section 85 (cruelty by husband or relatives, formerly Section 498A IPC, in force 1 July 2024); and India safeguarding routes (Women Helpline 181, women-in-distress 1091, emergency 112, Childline 1098, and counsellors). Warm and even-handed, family-respecting and never cut-off by default, with a clear friction-vs-abuse line; legal points are general information, not legal advice. Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 57 games now v2. Next by order: Money Together (g58).